From Pilot to Scale: Stakeholder & Productization Strategy for InvoiceMatch

Strategy memo for the Silverbrook Financial leadership review · Prepared by **Umashanker** · November 2026

> **Context.** InvoiceMatch is an AI-assisted accounts payable (AP) tool. Claude reads supplier invoices, written rules check them against purchase orders and contracts, and people approve every exception (live product, source). Silverbrook Financial is fictional, and the pilot figures below are illustrative sample data.

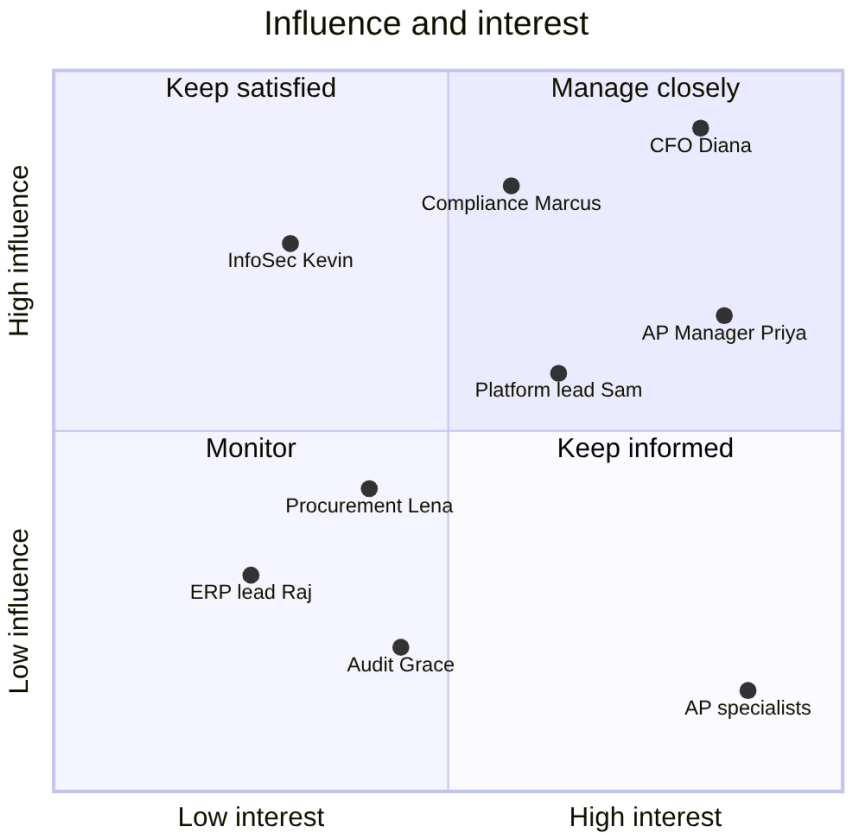
Executive summary

The 8-week pilot proved the technology: 100% field accuracy and zero wrong automatic approvals on the benchmark, at about $0.0002 per invoice. **Adoption is uneven.** One AP team uses InvoiceMatch for most invoices; the second still checks most invoices by hand, because it does not yet trust the explanations and fears being measured by the tool. Procurement and Internal Audit are barely engaged.

Recommendation: do not scale by mandate. Spend the next 90 days making the pilot team's success repeatable: fix the trust gaps the second team named, give each stakeholder an owner and a cadence, measure adoption with the scorecard below, and package InvoiceMatch as an internal product with clear service boundaries. Expand to full volume only when the day-90 gates are met.

1. Stakeholder map

Built with PMI stakeholder analysis (influence × interest), extended with each group's expected benefit, concern, and likely resistance.



Stakeholder	Influence / interest	Expected benefit	Main concern	Likely resistance
Diana, CFO (sponsor)	High / High	57% less manual effort; payback in about 7 months	ROI not proven at full volume	Low; turns into doubt if metrics slip
Marcus, Compliance	High / Medium	Every decision explained and logged	Automation bypassing approval limits	Medium: blocks any limit change without evidence
Kevin, InfoSec	High / Low	Governed AI instead of staff pasting invoices into chatbots	Data leaving the account; key misuse	Medium: slow security reviews
Priya, AP Manager	Medium / High	Team off overtime; exceptions explained	Being blamed for AI mistakes	Low; she is the champion

Stakeholder	Influence / interest	Expected benefit	Main concern	Likely resistance
Sam, AI Platform lead	Medium / Medium	A reusable pattern for other teams	One-off code that cannot be reused	Low
Lena, Procurement	Low–Med / Medium	Price-drift data for vendor talks	More "fix this PO" requests	Medium: passive, slow responses
Raj, ERP lead	Low / Low	Fewer manual ERP status updates	Extra integration load	Low–medium: low priority
Grace, Internal Audit	Low / Medium	Faster, complete audit samples	Losing independent review	Low
AP specialists (6 people, two teams)	Low / High	Routine checking disappears	Job security; being monitored	**High in team B**: workarounds, manual re-checks

Key insight: the people with the most interest have the least influence. The AP specialists decide whether the tool is used day to day, so their concerns must reach the sponsor quickly.

2. Engagement plan

Stakeholder	Approach	Owner	Cadence	Escalation path	Success indicator
CFO	One-page scorecard; decisions only	FDE lead	Every 2 weeks	Steering committee	Funds release 1 at the day-90 review
Compliance	Rule-change reviews with evidence packs	AP Manager	Monthly; ad hoc for changes	CFO	No unapproved limit changes; sign-off in < 10 days
InfoSec	Security review of every release; access reviews	Platform lead	Each release; quarterly	CIO	Release reviews completed within SLA
AP Manager	Co-owner of the rollout and the backlog	FDE lead	Weekly	CFO	Team B adoption reaches target
AP specialists	Hands-on clinics; floor champions; "you said, we did" notes	AP Manager + champions	Weekly 30-minute session	AP Manager → steering committee	Satisfaction ≥ 4/5; manual re-checks falling
Procurement	Monthly mismatch report (price drift, wrong POs)	FDE analyst	Monthly	CFO	PO fixes within 3 days
ERP lead	Integration roadmap slot	Platform lead	Monthly	CIO	ERP write live by day 60
Internal Audit	Weekly random sample of 50 decisions	AP Manager	Weekly	Audit Committee	Agreement ≥ 98%

Change model. We follow Kotter's 8 steps, compressed into three moves. First, *urgency and coalition*: the CFO and AP Manager present the overtime and leakage numbers together. Second, *vision and quick wins*: team A's results are shared in team B's own words. Third, *anchoring*: InvoiceMatch becomes the standard AP procedure, with shadow mode retired only by the AP Manager.

3. Change and adoption scorecard

Measured with Prosci-style change metrics plus product usage data. Day-0 values are from the pilot; day-90 values are targets.

Area	Metric	How measured	Day 0	Day 90 target
Readiness	Staff who agree "I understand why we are changing"	Pulse survey	58%	≥ 85%
Training	Staff who completed role-based training	LMS records	67%	100%
Activation	Specialists who processed ≥ 20 invoices in a week	Audit log	4 of 6	6 of 6
Usage	Share of eligible invoices processed through InvoiceMatch	Audit log	64% (team A 88%, team B 40%)	≥ 90% both teams
Feature adoption	Exceptions resolved inside the review queue, not by email	Queue vs mailbox	45%	≥ 80%

Area	Metric	How measured	Day 0	Day 90 target
Proficiency	Median time to resolve an exception	Queue timestamps	3.1 days	≤ 1 day
Satisfaction	AP user satisfaction (1–5)	Monthly survey	3.4	≥ 4.2
Support volume	Support tickets per 1,000 invoices	Service desk	9	≤ 3
Process compliance	Auto-approved invoices re-checked by hand (shadow work)	Sample of logs	30%	≤ 5%
Business value	Manual AP hours per month	Time study	610 (baseline 790)	≤ 450, on the way to 342
Safety (guardrail)	Wrong automatic approvals	Audit sample	0	0 (stop rule)

Reading the scorecard: usage is the headline, but *shadow work* is the real signal. Team B re-checks auto-approved invoices because it does not trust them. Until that drops, the business value cannot arrive.

4. Productization strategy

Element	Strategy
Target users	Primary: AP specialists and managers. Secondary: approvers (Controller, CFO), Procurement, Internal Audit. Next: other Silverbrook finance teams with document checks (expenses, vendor onboarding)
Value proposition	"Routine invoices approve themselves within your limits; every exception arrives explained, with the evidence attached."
MVP / core offering	PO-backed digital USD invoices: AI reading, 10 matching rules, approval routing, review queue, audit log, ERP status update
Service boundaries	*In:* reading, matching, routing, explanations, audit. *Out:* payments, PO or vendor changes, non-PO invoices (release 3). The AI never approves; rules and people do
Onboarding	45-minute role training; sandbox with sample invoices; floor champion per team; two weeks in shadow mode per team before live use
Support	L1 service desk; L2 AP platform team with the runbook; L3 FDE/vendor engineering. Target: Sev 1 response in 15 minutes
Governance	Product owner: AP Manager. Technical owner: AI Platform lead. Rule and limit changes need Compliance sign-off; each release passes the accuracy and safety gates
Funding / pricing logic	Year 1: CFO-funded from savings (about $313k net a year). From year 2: internal chargeback per invoice processed (about $0.25 covers platform, support, and AI cost), so new teams pay for what they use
Operational risks	AI gateway outage (falls back to rules; people review); model drift (monthly benchmark); key exposure (15-minute rotation); team B rejection (see the 90-day plan)

Roadmap.

Horizon	Release	Scope	Gate to start
Now (0–3 months)	Release 1 at full volume	Both AP teams; trust fixes; ERP status write	Day-90 gates met
Next (3–6 months)	Release 2	Bank-change verification workflow; Procurement price-drift report; scanned invoices	Release 1 stable for 6 weeks
Later (6–12 months)	Platform	"Safe document AI" module reused for expenses and vendor onboarding; non-PO invoices	Second internal customer funded

5. Prioritized 90-day action plan

Priority	Action	Owner	By day	Linked metric
1	Run listening sessions with team B; publish the top 5 trust gaps and their fixes	AP Manager + FDE lead	10	Readiness, satisfaction
2	Ship the two most requested fixes: contract link on the review screen; plain-language reason on every hold	FDE team	30	Shadow work, proficiency
3	Name two floor champions in team B; pair each with a team A champion	AP Manager	14	Activation

Priority	Action	Owner	By day	Linked metric
4	Complete role training for everyone; add a 15-minute refresher in team meetings	AP Manager	30	Training
5	Agree with HR and the CFO, in writing, that tool data is not used for individual performance reviews	CFO	21	Readiness, satisfaction
6	Turn on the ERP status write and retire the manual double entry	ERP lead	60	Usage, hours
7	Start the monthly Procurement mismatch report	FDE analyst	45	Proficiency
8	Publish the bi-weekly scorecard to the steering committee	FDE lead	From 14	All
9	Hand L2 support to the AP platform team after two incident drills	Platform lead	75	Support volume
10	**Day-90 review:** scale to full volume if usage ≥ 90%, shadow work ≤ 5%, 0 wrong approvals, and satisfaction ≥ 4.2; otherwise extend by 30 days	CFO + steering committee	90	Gates

Why this order: trust comes first (actions 1–5). Without it, removing double entry (6) or reporting usage (8) only increases pressure on team B. Ownership transfer (9) comes last, once the process is stable.

Decision requested

Approve the 90-day plan, the named owners, and the day-90 gates. Confirm in writing that InvoiceMatch data will not be used to rate individual employees.

Frameworks used: PMI stakeholder analysis; Prosci change-management metrics; Kotter's 8-step change model; product lifecycle staging (now / next / later).